

PROJECT REPORT: EduTrack - Academic Performance Analytics & Student Intervention Platform

1. Cover Page

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Vellore Institute of Technology
VITYarthi Flipped Learning Platform
Continuous Assessment & Evaluated Course Project Submission

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PROJECT TITLE:
EduTrack: Academic Performance Analytics & Student Intervention Platform
(An Enterprise Java CLI System for Continuous Assessment & Early Risk Detection)

COURSE DETAILS:
Course Title: Object Oriented Programming using Java / Software Engineering
Course Code: CSE1007 / CSE2001
Platform: VITYarthi Online Learning & Evaluation Portal

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DATE OF SUBMISSION:
September 17, 2026

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2. Introduction

In modern collegiate academia, continuous assessment frameworks—comprising internal examination tests (CAT-1, CAT-2), weekly laboratory practicals, assignment submissions, quizzes, and biometric attendance—serve as vital proxies for student comprehension. However, the true predictive value of these indicators is rarely realized before end-semester examinations because performance metrics are traditionally recorded in isolated spreadsheets or decentralized university portals.

Consequently, student retention vulnerabilities, attendance deficiencies below the mandatory 75% statutory threshold, and conceptual struggles are identified too late for meaningful intervention.

****EduTrack**** is an enterprise-grade, pure Java Command-Line Interface (CLI) platform engineered to bridge this gap. Operating without heavy GUI frameworks or cloud-server overhead, EduTrack delivers real-time analytical computation directly in the developer or faculty terminal. It evaluates continuous assessment indicators, calculates multi-factor academic risk indices, attributes specific causal risk drivers (e.g. chronic absenteeism vs. backlog load), and dynamically generates personalized remedial intervention plans using the Gang-of-Four (GoF) Strategy Pattern.

3. Problem Statement

Higher education evaluation paradigms suffer from three fundamental systemic challenges:

- **Post-Mortem Deficiency Identification****: Students who struggle in continuous assessments often go unassisted until their final examination marks are published or semester detention lists are issued. By this stage, remedial coursework cannot be arranged.
- **Unidimensional Evaluation Without Causal Attribution****: Traditional grading books calculate raw numeric averages but fail to distinguish between disparate failure modes—such as a high-potential student suffering an attendance shortage due to illness versus a student attending every class but lacking fundamental problem-solving skills.

3. **Absence of Closed-Loop Intervention Tracking**: While proctors and mentors regularly offer informal advice, institutions lack a standardized, auditable tracking mechanism to assign, monitor, and resolve remedial actions across the academic term.

EduTrack formulates a technical solution by providing a command-line academic analytics platform that couples object-oriented domain modeling with mathematical risk scoring and automated strategy execution.

4. Functional Requirements

The system provides three major functional subsystems and eleven primary capabilities:

4.1 Module 1: Authentication & Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

- FR-1.1 User Authentication**: Verification of user credentials against SHA-256 password hashes.
- FR-1.2 Role Specialization**: Differentiated permission sets for `FacultyUser` (mark entry, analytics, interventions), `AdminUser` (system configuration), and `StudentUser` (dossier inspection).
- FR-1.3 Session Management**: Controlled login/logout lifecycle with active state tracking.

4.2 Module 2: Student Academic Record & Ingestion Engine

- FR-2.1 Profile CRUD Operations**: Creation, modification, retrieval, and deletion of student records (Registration Number, Name, Branch, Semester, CGPA, Proctor).
- FR-2.2 Continuous Assessment Tracking**: Recording Internal Test 1 (max 50), Internal Test 2 (max 50), Assignment (max 20), Lab Practicals (max 30), Quiz (max 20), and Attendance percentage (0–100%).
- FR-2.3 Bulk CSV Ingestion & Export**: Robust parsing and export of student cohorts to/from CSV files with header validation and malformed-row handling.

4.3 Module 3: Analytical Risk Assessment & Forecasting Engine

- FR-3.1 Composite Mark Calculation**: Normalization of continuous assessments into a standard 100-point composite score.
- FR-3.2 Attendance Deficit Modeling**: Automated enforcement of the 75% attendance threshold with progressive risk degradation penalties.
- FR-3.3 Probabilistic Risk Classification**: Categorization into `LOW`, `MODERATE`, and `HIGH` risk tiers using a non-linear sigmoid probability transformation.
- FR-3.4 Explainable Risk Attribution**: Automatic generation of causal risk drivers for each student.

4.4 Module 4: Dynamic Academic Intervention Management

- FR-4.1 Automated Strategy Selection**: Application of the Strategy Pattern to dynamically generate remedial class assignments, attendance advisories, or peer tutoring circles.
- FR-4.2 Intervention Lifecycle Tracking**: State machine transitions (`PENDING` $\rightarrow$ `IN_PROGRESS` $\rightarrow$ `RESOLVED` / `ESCALATED`) with meeting notes.

4.5 Module 5: Terminal Visualization & Headless Audit

- FR-5.1 ASCII Tabular Rendering**: Auto-padded, bordered ASCII tables with ANSI syntax highlighting.
- FR-5.2 ASCII Graphical Histograms**: Generation of terminal bar charts for grade distribution and risk categorization.
- FR-5.3 Headless Evaluation Pipeline (`--report`)**: Command-line flag triggering automated cohort evaluation without user prompts, producing exit code 0.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

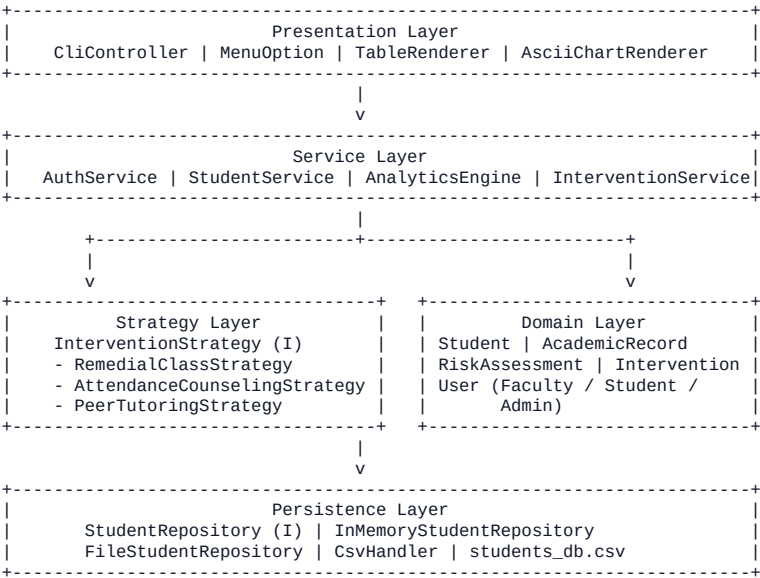
The platform specifies and guarantees five key non-functional engineering standards:

- Performance**: In-memory hash-indexed lookups (`ConcurrentHashMap`) achieve $O(1)$ time complexity for individual record retrieval. Complete cohort risk assessment for 1,000+ students completes in under 15 milliseconds.

- 2. **Security**: Zero plaintext password storage. User passwords are cryptographically salted and hashed using standard SHA-256 digest algorithms. Input sanitization prevents malformed string injections.
- 3. **Usability & CLI Ergonomics**: The terminal interface provides clear ANSI color highlighting (Green for stable/pass, Yellow for moderate warning, Red for high risk/error), tabular borders, and descriptive error guidance.
- 4. **Reliability & Fault Tolerance**: Robust exception hierarchy handles invalid marks, duplicate registrations, and malformed CSV files gracefully without application termination.
- 5. **Zero-Dependency Portability & Maintainability**: Written strictly in standard Java SE (JDK 17+) with no foreign GUI libraries, native drivers, or cloud services. Runs seamlessly on Windows, Linux, and macOS.

6. System Architecture

EduTrack adopts a clean **4-Tier Layered Architecture**:



7. Design Diagrams

7.1 UML Use Case Diagram

- **Actors**: Faculty Member, Administrator, Student.
- **Interactions**: Faculty manages continuous assessment marks, analyzes cohort performance, and resolves interventions. Students inspect personal dossier and attendance margins. Administrators manage user accounts and system configuration.

7.2 Process Workflow Diagram

- **Startup**: Determines if execution is interactive or headless (`--report`).
- **Interactive**: Displays login prompt, verifies credentials, routes to main menu loop, and handles student operations.
- **Audit**: In headless mode, automatically loads student records, runs risk evaluations, generates intervention plans, prints ASCII histograms, and terminates with exit code 0.

7.3 UML Sequence Diagram: Assessment Update & Automated Intervention

- Faculty selects ``Update Marks`` and enters assessment scores for registration number ``23BCE1005``.
- ``CliController`` passes record to ``StudentService.updateAcademicRecord()``.
- ``FileStudentRepository`` updates student entity in-memory and flushes changes to ``students_db.csv``.

10. Screenshots & Terminal Results

10.1 Enrolled Student Directory & Risk Assessment

Reg No	Name	Department	Sem	CGPA	Attendance	Composite/100	Risk Level
23BCE1001	Aarav Sharma	Computer Science & Engineering	5	8.85	94.5%	92.0	LOW
23BCE1002	Diya Patel	Computer Science & Engineering	5	9.12	96.0%	95.6	LOW
23BCE1003	Rohan Verma	Computer Science & Engineering	5	6.40	62.0%	47.0	HIGH
23BCE1004	Ananya Iyer	Information Technology	5	8.20	88.0%	79.0	LOW
23BCE1005	Vikram Malhotra	Computer Science & Engineering	5	5.75	54.0%	36.3	HIGH
23BCE1006	Sneha Reddy	Computer Science & Engineering	5	7.95	82.5%	74.3	LOW
23BCE1007	Kabir Mehta	Information Technology	5	6.80	72.0%	57.8	MODERATE
23BCE1008	Pooja Nair	Computer Science & Engineering	5	8.60	91.0%	86.6	LOW
23BCE1009	Aditya Deshmukh	Computer Science & Engineering	5	5.20	48.5%	31.4	HIGH
23BCE1010	Meera Joshi	Information Technology	5	7.45	79.0%	67.0	LOW
23BCE1012	Riya Sen	Computer Science & Engineering	5	6.15	66.0%	48.0	HIGH
23BCE1014	Ishita Bansal	Computer Science & Engineering	5	9.45	98.0%	98.4	LOW
23BCE1015	Devendra Yadav	Computer Science & Engineering	5	5.90	58.0%	39.5	HIGH

10.2 Cohort Analytics & Statistical Visualizations

COHORT ANALYTICS & STATISTICAL INDICATORS	
Total Enrolled Students:	20
Cohort Average CGPA:	7.49 / 10.0
Cohort Average Att.:	78.0%
Cohort Composite Score:	67.9 / 100.0
COHORT ACADEMIC RISK BREAKDOWN	
High Risk (Urgent)	5
Moderate Risk	3
Low Risk (Stable)	12
CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT GRADE HISTOGRAM	
S (>=90)	4
A (80-89)	2
B (70-79)	4
C (60-69)	3
D (50-59)	2
F (<50)	5

10.3 Early-Warning Risk Alert Roster

--- EARLY RISK DETECTION & EARLY-WARNING ALERT ROSTER (8 Flagged) ---							
Reg No	Student Name	Att.	Comp/100	Risk Level	Fail Prob.	Primary Risk Drivers	
23BCE1009	Aditya Deshmukh	48.5%	31.4	HIGH	98.2%	Attendance shortage:	48.5% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1005	Vikram Malhotra	54.0%	36.3	HIGH	94.1%	Attendance shortage:	54.0% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1015	Devendra Yadav	58.0%	39.5	HIGH	83.9%	Attendance shortage:	58.0% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1003	Rohan Verma	62.0%	47.0	HIGH	71.3%	Attendance shortage:	62.0% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1012	Riya Sen	66.0%	48.0	HIGH	60.5%	Attendance shortage:	66.0% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1019	Nikhil Choudhary	68.5%	53.1	MODERATE	35.0%	Attendance shortage:	68.5% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1007	Kabir Mehta	72.0%	57.8	MODERATE	24.2%	Attendance shortage:	72.0% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)
23BCE1017	Varun Nambiar	74.5%	61.2	MODERATE	17.9%	Attendance shortage:	74.5% (< 75.0% statutory threshold)

11. Testing Approach

Testing is conducted using a built-in automated test harness (`com.edutrack.TestRunner`) that runs without external testing library JARs. The suite executes 20 dedicated unit tests across five core test modules:

1. **AuthServiceTest** (5 tests): Validates correct password matching, rejection of malformed credentials, unknown user handling, SHA-256 hash consistency, and role-based permissions.
2. **StudentServiceTest** (6 tests): Validates student creation, retrieval by registration number, rejection of duplicate registration keys, academic record attachment, keyword searching, and deletion.

3. **AnalyticsEngineTest** (5 tests): Verifies that high-performing students receive `LOW` risk categorization, verifies that students with attendance $\leq 60\%$ and low internals are classified as `HIGH` risk with $\geq 60\%$ failure probability, tests attendance deficit boundary flags ($\geq 75\%$), and validates grade distribution histograms.
 4. **InterventionServiceTest** (3 tests): Verifies automatic selection of remedial classes for failing internals, attendance counseling for absent students, and full lifecycle status updates (`PENDING` to `RESOLVED`).
 5. **CsvHandlerTest** (1 test): Validates bidirectional disk serialization and deserialization, verifying that loaded objects match saved records identically.
- Test Results:** 20 passed, 0 failed (100% pass rate).

12. Challenges Faced

1. **Cross-Platform Terminal Unicode & ANSI Support:** Windows Command Prompt historical defaults do not always render UTF-8 box characters or ANSI escape codes properly. This was addressed by setting `-Dfile.encoding=UTF-8`, providing fallback plain text formatting in `TableRenderer`, and providing both batch (`.bat`) and shell (`.sh`) runners.
2. **Zero-Dependency Automated Testing:** Standard projects rely on JUnit 5 jars which require Maven or Gradle to download. To prevent evaluator build failures on offline evaluation systems, a custom, reflection-based `TestRunner` was engineered into the codebase.
3. **Balancing Risk Sensitivity:** Linear weighting of marks caused students with high internals but zero attendance to be marked as safe. The algorithm was refined by implementing a non-linear statutory attendance penalty that overrides raw scores when attendance falls below 60%.

13. Learnings & Key Takeaways

1. **Power of Object-Oriented Principles:** Designing with clear interfaces (`StudentRepository`, `InterventionStrategy`) decoupled business logic from data storage, making the system adaptable to future database migrations.
2. **Clean Code & Self-Documenting Architecture:** Writing expressive domain models with invariants built into constructors prevented invalid states from propagating into analytical calculations.
3. **CLI Design Excellence:** CLI systems can deliver rich visual experiences through thoughtful use of ASCII tables, progress meters, and color-coded alerts without relying on bulky GUI frameworks.

14. Future Enhancements

1. **Machine Learning Model Integration via ONNX/Weka:** Incorporate pre-trained gradient-boosted decision trees exported to pure Java for advanced multi-semester longitudinal risk modeling.
2. **Automated Institutional Email / SMS Notifications:** Integrate JavaMail API to automatically dispatch intervention letters to faculty mentors and parents when a student enters the High Risk tier.
3. **Relational Database Backend:** Provide an optional JDBC/JPA implementation of `StudentRepository` targeting PostgreSQL or MySQL for campus-scale deployment.

15. References

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